

Youssef Mahmoud Desouki

Cyber Security Researcher & Penetration Tester

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cyber Security Researcher and Offensive Security Specialist with over 5+ years of hands-on experience in penetration testing, vulnerability research, and bug bounty programs. Reported and validated 600+ security vulnerabilities across leading organizations including Apple, PayPal, Adobe, TikTok, Shopify, and Eurofins.

Recognized in multiple Hall of Fame listings and acknowledged by global security teams for impactful findings such as business logic vulnerabilities, authentication bypasses, IDOR, Stored/Reflected XSS, CSRF, and account takeover vectors.

Highly skilled in web application security, exploit development, and bypassing modern WAF filtering techniques. Seeking to contribute to advanced offensive security roles.

EDUCATION

Alexandria University <i>Bachelor of Tourism & Hotels</i> • Specialized in tourism management and hospitality operations. • Transitioned into cybersecurity through self-learning, practical experience, and professional bug bounty research.	2018
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Penetration Tester - Apple (Freelance) <i>Penetration Tester</i> • Conducted penetration testing on Apple's core web services, Identifying 18+ high-severity vulnerabilities including Stored XSS, Authentication Bypass, and Logic Escapes. • Achieved dual Hall of Fame recognition (May 2025 & August 2022) for impactful discoveries and bypassing Apple's first-stage patch for a Stored XSS vulnerability. Collaborated directly with Apple Security Engineering teams for responsible disclosure and mitigation.	11/2022 – Present Alexandria, Egypt
HackerOne Global CTF & Live Hacking Events Participant <i>HackerOne Global CTF & Live Hacking Events Participant</i> • Participated in HackerOne CTFs and competitive security events. • Ranked among top participants in multiple challenges. • Specialized in web exploitation, logic bugs, and real-world vulnerability simulation.	2022 – Present

Penetration Tester - HackerOne (Full-time)

01/2022 – Present

Alexandria, Egypt

Penetration Tester

- Performed web security assessments for top global clients including PayPal, Shopify, Twitter, TikTok, Eurofins, and Adobe.
- Discovered 600+ validated vulnerabilities, including Zero-Click Account Takeovers, Clickjacking, OAuth Weaknesses, Misconfigurations, and Business Logic Flaws.
- Ranked #21 in HackerOne Top 100 Security Researchers for consistent high-impact findings.
- Recognized in PayPal Hall of Fame (2025) for critical exploit development.

Penetration Tester - AXA

2023

Penetration Tester

Remote

- Conducted full-scope penetration testing on AXA's internal and customer facing applications.
- Identified and reported vulnerabilities including authentication issues, logic flaws, and XSS.
- Collaborated with the security engineering team to validate fixes and ensure secure deployment.

Security Engineer - Root Cyber

2023

Security Engineer

Remote

- Performed in depth penetration testing and vulnerability assessments on client infrastructure.
- Identified high-impact vulnerabilities across web and API systems. Collaborated with senior engineers to implement advanced security controls.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Penetration Testing & Vulnerability Research

- IDOR XSS
(Stored/Reflected/DOM)
CSRF Business Logic Exploits
- Authentication Bypass
Privilege Escalation Session Weaknesses
- OAuth 2.0 / SSO Attacks
SSRF Basics Clickjacking
WAF Bypass

Tools

- Burp Suite Pro Nmap
Metasploit Postman Fiddler
FFUF
- Recon Tools (Subfinder, Amass, Gau, Nuclei)

Programming

HTML Python JavaScript

Other Skills

Responsible Disclosure
Reporting Security
Documentation

PROJECTS & RESEARCH

Automated Pentesting Framework (Local HTML Tool)

Developed a lightweight local testing tool for scanning and identifying common vulnerabilities.

WAF & Filter Bypass Payload Library

Built a personal database of 30+ advanced payloads for XSS and encoding-based evasion techniques.

Browser Security Testing Suite

Designed a custom testing environment to evaluate iframe protections, CSP, and Same Origin Policy weaknesses.

LANGUAGES

Arabic

English

HONORS & AWARDS

Apple Hall of Fame

01/04/2025

Apple

Bypass of Stored XSS fix and critical vulnerability discovery.

PayPal Hall of Fame

01/03/2025

PayPal

For zero-click login flows and business logic vulnerabilities.

Apple Hall of Fame

01/07/2024

Apple

Acknowledged for contributions to security infrastructure.

Adobe Hall of Fame

01/12/2023

Adobe

Recognized for impactful contributions to Adobe Security.

Eurofins Hall of Fame

01/12/2022

Eurofins

Rewarded for major findings in authentication systems.

HackerOne Top 100 Security Researchers

HackerOne

(#21 Worldwide): Consistent excellence in offensive security.

VOLUNTEER & COMMUNITY EXPERIENCE

Security Researcher

2023 – Present

- Identified critical vulnerabilities across Apple's web systems.
- Earned two Hall of Fame listings for consistent contributions.

Remote

Security Researcher

2022 – Present

- Participated in top-tier bug bounty programs contributing to hundreds of validated vulnerabilities.
- Received multiple acknowledgments for impactful reports.

Remote